

TAIWAN

With a short but remarkable history of tea, the island of Taiwan is best known for the fragrant, fine-quality oolong teas, such as Tie Guan Yin and Ali Shan, that form the bulk of its production.

Taiwan, or Formosa as it was formerly known, was occupied by the Chinese in 1683, during the rule of the Qing dynasty, and became part of the Fujian province of China. Resettlers from the Wuyi mountains in Fujian brought their tea-growing skills with them and planted seeds on Taiwan's fertile mountains. As there were no manufacturing facilities in Taiwan, the tea was sent to Fujian for processing.

In 1868, British trader John Dodd helped to set up a plant in Taipei to process tea. This made manufacturing and exporting tea easier, giving Formosa tea worldwide recognition. Though

famous for its high-grown mountain oolongs, Taiwan is also known for producing many different styles of oolong, which are shipped worldwide and widely enjoyed in Taiwan.

The flavors of Taiwanese oolongs change seasonally. High mountain oolongs harvested in spring have a pronounced floral and fruity flavor, while oolongs harvested in the cooler winter weather are full-bodied with a fragrant aroma. The production methods for oxidized oolongs are quite time-consuming, the majority taking more than two days and up to 10 stages of production to complete.



HARVESTING TEA

Hand-picking is the preferred method for harvesting premium leaves in Taiwan, which are picked mainly as buds and young leaves.

TAIWAN KEY FACTS

PERCENTAGE
OF WORLD
PRODUCTION: **0.6%**

FAMOUS FOR:
**HIGH MOUNTAIN
OOLONGS**

ELEVATION: **MEDIUM-HIGH**

MAIN TYPES:

**OOLONG,
BLACK, GREEN**

HARVEST:
**5 TIMES A YEAR FROM
APRIL-DECEMBER**

80 PERCENT
OF THE TEA
GROWN IN
TAIWAN
IS BOUGHT
BY ITS
TEA-LOVING
DOMESTIC
MARKET